



Motherboards

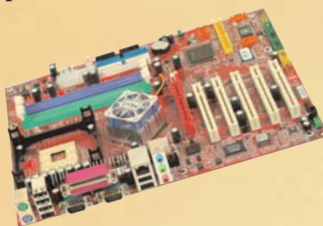
Intel Motherboards MSI 875P Neo FISR

Specs: i875 Chipset, supports DDR 400 MHz, AGP 8X, 2 SATA ports, 7.1 channel sound, 8 USB ports, Gigabit Ethernet and FireWire ports.

Our verdict: The 875P Neo FISR from MSI is still the best board money can buy, when it comes to the older socket 478 Pentium 4 processors running at 800 MHz FSB.

The 875P Neo board comes with MSI's Core cell chip that allows on-the-fly over-clocking, power saving and real-time diagnosis of critical system parameters such as temperature and fan speed. The board is packed to the gills with features, and delivers excellent performance.

Runner-up:
Intel
D875PBZ



AMD Motherboards Asus A7N8X-E Deluxe

Specs: nVidia Nforce2 Chipset, twin Gigabit Ethernet, 802.11b Wi-Fi card, SoundStorm Audio, SATA ports, 6 USB ports and FireWire port.

Our verdict: The Asus A7N8X is, till date, the best motherboard you can buy for AMD's Socket-A processors. The motherboard is based around nVidia's nForce2 chipset.

On the features front, the board comes with two Gigabit adapters and one 802.11b Wi-Fi card for wireless connectivity. The SoundStorm audio processing unit is capable of decoding Dolby sound. The performance of this board is trailblazing, the over-clocking capabilities excellent and it even remains fairly stable on over-clocking.

Runner-up:
Asus K7V600



Multifunctional Devices

WorkGroup MFDs Samsung SCX-4216F

Specs: 600x600 dpi, 16 PPM, 250 sheets, 4800x4800 dpi scanner, 160 pages fax memory and super G3 compatible

Our Verdict: The laser SCX-4216F MFD from Samsung offers an excellent balance of performance and features. A good printer unit, a reasonably good flatbed scanner and faxing capabilities make it an ideal choice for an office.

Runner-up:
HP LJ3380



Heavy Duty MFDs Samsung SCX-5315F

Specs: 15 PPM, 1,200 dpi, USB/Parallel interface, 600x600 dpi scanning, 550 sheets capacity, 320 pages fax memory and 80 location speed dial

Our Verdict: Samsung's SCX-5315F is a huge and sturdy machine. The printing unit is based on a copier engine and provides good economy. The scanner unit, although slow, is up to the mark. Copying is fast and additional features such as clone, duplicate, and paper save give the SCX-5315F the edge.

Runner-up:
Xerox M15i



Flashback To December 2000

Asus A7V

Specs: VIA KT133 Chipset, supports 1 GHz AMD processor, 1.5 GB PC133 SDRAM.

Evolution: As of today, the Asus A7N8X-E is a powerhouse, and will run rings around the Asus A7V. The Asus A7V was then king, but it cannot stand up to the latest boards. The A7N8X supports an AMD processor up to 2.4 GHz and memories running at 400 MHz. While the lowly Asus A7V was priced at Rs 12,000, the new, technology-packed A7N8X is priced at Rs 8,000 only.

Multifunctional Devices (All-in-ones, as they were then called)

Evolution: When MFDs were introduced in the market, they weren't successful thanks mainly to reliability issues. Also, many of the units didn't perform as good as their standalone counterparts did. Manufacturers were pushed to the drawing boards again and they came out with really good machines that combined three or four devices into a single unit. As of today, they have evolved to such an extent that they produce results on par or better than their standalone counterparts.

